

Reflection Paper Humility (Murray) Text

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General Overview

One of the chapters I loved the most was: “Humility and Death to Self”¹ Ultimately, humility means that we are crushed and that God is exalted. But it is not so much that we “walk around with dark clouds of condemnation hanging over their heads.” We need to realize “how wonderful and natural it is to become “nothing.” This means that it is glorious to be humble.

The main purpose of the author is that humility is a beautiful thing, and that it is the essence and root of the relationship with Christ. With it, we realize that all we have is Christ, and that Christ is the only power and value we have.

He was trying to convey that God needs to crush us, and that through our knowledge of our insignificance, we realize the lavishness of his grace.

Key Points

1) **The crushing of God**. This means that by crushing us, we realize that we are nothing - we are less than nothing because we are sinners. God crushes us, and destroys us, and we look up and cry out, “Oh holy God! Save me!” And when God blesses us and treats us with grace, we realize the supremacy of God and our lowliness.

I was touched by the fact that God loves me, and that being worthless and nothing is a good way of realizing that God is all I have.

2) **Pride is the root of sin**. What I realize is that “pride—the loss of this humility—is the root of every sin and evil.” When we start thinking that we are strong, and good, and worthy, we lose that dependence on God and we depend on our mortal and non-omnipotent self. This leads to self-exaltation above God and leading, and determining, and choosing by our own intelligence

¹ Andrew Murray, *Humility: The Journey Toward Holiness* (Function, Kindle edition), 4.

and will and wisdom above God's. God absolutely hates that, and this pride causes all sorts of sin. In fact, if we lose pride, we may lose all sin. Pride causes all evil.

What I didn't realize was how much pride I have and how this is blocking my progress in my life.

Personal Application

"A lack of humility is the only explanation you need for every flaw and failure you have." I believe this is my problem. I am still too strong in my abilities, and I look to my own self for my knowledge of the sciences. But once my humility is fully in place and my knowledge is fully and truly perfected in Christ, God can use my business and science knowledge.

I want to lead, I want to heal, I want to minister, I want to be a CEO, I want to research Computer Science, but all these things are blocked - possibly because I need to repent and be humble. It starts with humility, continues with humility, and should end humble. This is the phrase that Job used, "I started with nothing, and why should I not end with nothing - he gives and he takes away, blessed be the name of the Lord."

Therefore, with this in mind, I should be faithful and competent and satisfied with what God gives. I can pray for more, but God will always give me what I need and what I deserve, nothing less. Humility means accepting whatever God gives, because I acknowledge that God is God and is greater and is the one who can determine my life.

"Nothing is so wonderful and godly as being the servant and helper of all!" As we can see through this quote, it is a wonderful thing to be humble. We are not crushed and in despair - oh no; in fact, we are crushed, and we rejoice! We see that God is working in us, and getting rid of our pride and sin. He will always be a good God, and so when we are crushed, we are

conformed more to the image of a servant - and this is truly the blessed place to be. By being a servant we are able to serve others and be truly satisfied with whatever God gives us.

“I want to know him, and I want to know the power of his resurrection and the partaking of his sufferings!” (Philippians) “Let us remember Christ’s humility, that he became lowly and a servant so that he can die - die even a death on a cross for us” (Philippians).

Yes, me too! I want to know Christ! I want to know his wounds and his scars, so that I can inherit the great blessing of being a servant. I want to bless the Lord and be loved and full of joy even when I have nothing. This is an unstoppable force where no matter how low I am brought down, I can rejoice and be happy.

So many people want to be happy - this is the goal of life. We want to enjoy good food so that we can be happy, and we want to buy things so that we can be happy.

But what if we can be supremely happy in how low we are brought down? Beautiful is the feet that truly share this gospel of peace and love and humility.

By being humble, I can finally start ministry. I have learned the beginning step of a minister, and to live a faithful life in Christ.

I can lead, because leaders will make mistakes - and by making mistakes, we learn that we are humble and need the support of our followers.

God, I pray that you help me to lead and yet be humble, to love you and be excellent and great, and yet be humble.

Make me a man of God who can exalt your name and be crushed by your love. Humble me!